

2-Week International Client Acquisition Handbook

Enterprise Design Systems Architect • Senior UX Leader
B2B SaaS • Cybersecurity • US / UK / EU Markets

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Action started: Mon 27 Apr 2026 • Target: First international client in 14 days

Where You Are Right Now

ASSETS READY	CONTACTS LOADED	PIPELINE STAGES	ACTIVE SENDS
4	24	0	0
Site, CV, case study, handbooks	CPOs, VPs, Founders — US SaaS/AI	Not set up yet	0 emails sent

Diagnosis: Distribution problem, not a capability problem.

You have a credible site, a cybersecurity design-system case study (CYGNVS / SecureVault), HEX Portal token architecture (180+ tokens, 60+ components, cross-platform), two lead magnets (SEO Playbook, Analytics Handbook), and 24 qualified US contacts. Nothing is moving because there is no send motion and no reply pipeline.

The fix is not more assets. It is activating what already exists.

The Gap: From skilled designer to problem-solving consultant

CURRENT PERCEPTION	TARGET PERCEPTION
Skilled designer with strong execution	Enterprise design systems architect who connects UX to revenue
11+ years experience, good portfolio	"I help B2B SaaS and security teams turn UX and design systems into measurable conversion and speed gains"

Realistic 2-week target (honest framing)

Landing a signed, full project cold in 14 days is possible but not the base case. The high-probability win is 1-3 discovery calls and 1 paid UX Audit (\$750) as the wedge, converting to a larger retainer in weeks 3-6. This handbook closes an audit, not a full project.

Before Day 1: Three Locks (90 min, do not skip)

01**POSITIONING**

One line. Freeze it everywhere.

"I help B2B SaaS and security teams turn UX and design systems into measurable conversion and speed gains."

Your CYGNVS cybersecurity work is the differentiator almost no freelance designer has. Lead with it into security/AI accounts.

02**THE OFFER (THE WEDGE)**

One productized entry point. Calendar-bookable.

SaaS UX Audit

5-day teardown of one core flow (onboarding, activation, or dashboard). Deliverable: prioritized issue list, before/after direction, conversion-impact action plan. Fixed fee: \$750. Credited toward any follow-on project.

03**PIPELINE TRACKING**

Add 5 stages to your outreach CRM.

To Send → Sent → Replied → Call Booked → Won

If replies < 4 by Day 5, the problem is personalization, not volume. Fix the opening line before sending more.

Daily Motion (75 min / day, Mon-Fri)

ACTIVITY	TARGET	CHANNEL	TIME
Cold outreach	5 emails/day	eswar@eswarcreatives.in	30 min
LinkedIn connect + message	5 DMs/day	LinkedIn	20 min
Follow-up sweep	Sent +3 days	Email + LinkedIn	10 min
LinkedIn post	3x/week (M/W/F)	LinkedIn	15 min

Volume math

50 email touches + 50 LinkedIn over 14 days → 4-8 replies → 2-4 calls → 1-2 audits closed

Copy-Ready Outreach Templates

EMAIL TEMPLATE A — Security / AI Accounts

Targets: Fiddler AI, Defense Unicorns, Skill AI, Hydrosat

From: eswar@eswarcreatives.in

Subject: A UX friction point in {{Company}}'s onboarding

Hi {{First}},

I lead product design for enterprise SaaS, most recently building the design system for CYGNVS, an AI cybersecurity platform (60+ components, 180+ tokens across web, iOS and Android).

I looked at {{Company}}'s {{specific flow}} and spotted 2-3 friction points that are likely costing you activation. Happy to send a short teardown, no strings.

If it's useful, I run a fixed 5-day UX Audit that turns those into a prioritized, conversion-focused action plan. Worth a 20-minute call?

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EMAIL TEMPLATE B — SaaS Product Accounts

Targets: Render, Fieldguide, Nexxa, Goodday Software, Zocks, Opendate

From: eswar@eswarcreatives.in

Subject: 2 quick UX wins for {{Company}}

Hi {{First}},

Quick one. I design UX and design systems for B2B SaaS and noticed {{specific observation about their product}}.

I put together 2 concrete improvements that could lift {{onboarding completion / time-to-value}}. Can I send them over?

Background: 15+ years in enterprise SaaS, design systems used across web and mobile.

Portfolio: eswarcreatives.in

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LINKEDIN CONNECT NOTE (300 chars)

Targets: All accounts

Hi {{First}}, I design UX/design systems for B2B SaaS (recently an AI-security platform). Spotted a couple of UX improvements in {{Company}}'s product I'd be glad to share. Would love to connect.

FOLLOW-UP (Sent +3 days)

Targets: Anyone at Sent stage with no reply

Hi {{First}}, floating this back up. I still have the 2 UX notes for {{Company}} ready. Want me to send them across?

Personalization rule — the one line that drives reply rate

Personalize the {{specific flow}} / {{specific observation}} line every single send. That one sentence is the difference between a 2% and 10% reply rate. No generic sends. If you cannot write a specific observation, skip that prospect and move to the next.

Priority Hit List — Week 1 Contacts

Start here. Strongest by title fit and CYGNVS story alignment.

NAME	COMPANY	TITLE	WHY FIRST	TEMPLATE
Amit Paka	Fiddler AI	Founder / COO / CPO	AI+security fit, founder decides fast	A
Defense Unicorns team	Defense Unicorns	Engineering-led	CYGNVS story lands hardest	A
Shashank Goel	Nexxa	Chief Product Officer	CPO, direct email available	A
Meagan Gamache	Render	VP of Product	Scaling infra SaaS, dashboard-heavy	B
Dhruv Dhingra	Fieldguide	VP Product	B2B workflow SaaS, audit-friendly	B
Dave Wardell	Goodday Software	Co-founder / CPO	Founder-CPO, fast decision loop	B
(Zocks team)	Zocks.io	AI for Advisors	AI-native fintech, UX-sensitive	B

Expand to ~40 targets by Day 3. Same profile: seed-Series B, US/UK/EU SaaS, security or dashboard-heavy, CPO/VP/Founder title.

14-Day Execution Calendar

WEEK 1 — BUILD THE MOTION

D1	Lock positioning copy. Set up \$750 audit offer page + Calendly link. Add 5 pipeline stages to outreach CRM. Personalize 5 email drafts.
D2	Send 5 emails (priority cut). 5 LinkedIn connects. LinkedIn post #1: "UX mistake I spotted in a well-known app."
D3	10 touches. Expand target list to 40 using LinkedIn CSV + Apollo/ZoomInfo enrichment.
D4	10 touches. LinkedIn post #2: CYGNVS before/after snippet (token architecture visual).
D5	10 touches. Follow-up sweep on everyone at Sent stage. Review reply rate. If <4 replies, fix personalization before Day 8.

WEEK 2 — CONVERT

D8	10 touches. LinkedIn post #3: "Design-system ROI: consistency = shipping speed." Take/book any discovery calls.
D9	10 touches. On calls, sell the \$750 audit, not the project. Send audit proposals to warm replies. Keep proposal to 1 page.
D10	10 touches. Second follow-up sweep on Sent +6 days. Send free 2-point mini-teardown to your #1 warm lead to trigger the paid audit.
D11	10 touches. Chase all Replied contacts. Send "last call" to any warm leads not yet at Call Booked.

D14

Close 1 audit. Full funnel review: what reply rate, what source, what subject line worked. Build Week 3-4 send list from learnings.

Weekly Scorecard — Track Only These 5

Metric	Week 1 Target	Week 2 Target	W1 Actual	W2 Actual
Touches sent	50	50	—	—
Replies received	4+	4+	—	—
Calls booked	1+	2+	—	—
Audits proposed	0	2	—	—
Audits won (paid)	0	1	—	—

Reply-rate diagnostic

< 4 replies by Day 5 = personalization problem, not volume. Rewrite the opening line before sending more. > 4 replies = scale volume to 15/day in Week 2.

LinkedIn Content Plan (3 posts/week)

Post Type	Topic / Hook	Week	Authority Signal
UX mistake in popular app	Identify a friction point in a well-known SaaS onboarding	1	Observation + critique
Case study breakdown	CYGNVS before/after — token architecture visual	1	Proof of work
Design systems insight	Why 180+ semantic tokens beat raw hex values	1	Systems thinking
UX audit story	"I audited an onboarding flow and found this..."	2	Offer awareness
Before / after redesign	A real screen with 2 quick wins highlighted	2	Visual proof
Enterprise language post	Design debt, scalability, alignment — why global teams care	2	Positioning

Platform Setup Priority

Platform	Action	Priority	Effort
LinkedIn	Rewrite headline to positioning one-liner. Add CYGNVS metrics to About section.	Critical	30 min
eswarcreatives.in	Add Calendly link + \$750 audit offer CTA on homepage.	Critical	20 min
Calendly	Set up "30-min UX Audit Discovery Call" booking link.	Critical	10 min
Upwork	Create profile with same positioning one-liner. Link portfolio.	High	60 min
Contra	Set up independent profile. Good for async US/EU clients.	Medium	45 min
Dribbble / Behance	Upload CYGNVS case study visuals. Link to eswarcreatives.in.	Medium	60 min

Print this page. Fill it in by hand each day.

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PROPOSAL – SaaS UX Audit Eswar Maheswaran | eswar@eswarcreatives.in | eswarcreatives.in FOR: {{First Name}}, {{Company}} DATE: {{Date}} THE PROBLEM I OBSERVED {{2-3 sentences about the specific friction point you spotted in their product}} WHAT I WILL DELIVER (5 business days) 1. Full teardown of {{specific flow}} – every friction point mapped and prioritized 2. Before/after direction for the top 3 issues 3. Conversion-impact action plan: quick wins vs. structural fixes 4. 30-min walkthrough call on delivery INVESTMENT \$750 fixed fee. 100% credited toward any follow-on project. 50% on acceptance, 50% on delivery. NEXT STEP Reply "yes" to this email and I will send the invoice. Call: calendly.com/eswarcreatives/25-min-intro-call – Eswar

Enterprise Language That Resonates Globally

Use these words in emails, LinkedIn, and proposals. They signal design maturity to senior buyers — founders, CPOs, VPs of Product.

USE THIS	NOT THIS	WHY IT WORKS
Design debt	Design inconsistencies	Connects to engineering cost
Scalability	Grows with you	Enterprise procurement language
Design-to-dev efficiency	Faster handoffs	Measurable, CFO-legible
Token architecture	Color system	Shows systems thinking depth
Conversion-focused UX	Better UI	Ties design to revenue
Cross-platform consistency	Same look on mobile	Procurement / CTO concern
Audit and roadmap	Review and fix	Implies structured deliverable
ARR contribution	Helped revenue	Speaks CFO/CPO language

Target Client Profile

IDEAL	AVOID
■ Seed to Series C B2B SaaS	■ Agencies / branding shops
■ US / UK / EU markets	■ Consumer apps / e-commerce
■ Security, AI, fintech, data	■ Small UI tasks (<\$500)
■ Dashboard or workflow-heavy products	■ Single-platform (web-only)
■ CPO / Founder / VP Product buyer	■ Junior designer as gatekeeper
■ Team 10-100 engineers	■ No product-market fit yet

The winning formula (from your Notion strategy page)

Niche + Case Studies + Content + Outreach = International Clients

Even with 15+ years experience: without positioning + visibility, experience is invisible.

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